

8 HEALTH CARE



Health is not valued till sickness comes.

Dr. Thomas Fuller

The doctor of the future will give no medicine, but will interest her or his patients in the care of the human frame, in a proper diet, and in the cause and prevention of disease.

Thomas A. Edison

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **human body:** ankle, arm, armpit, back, bottom, (coll. belly), breast, calf, chest, cheek, chin, elbow, eye, eyebrow, eyelashes, eyelid, face, finger, foot, forehead, genitals, hair, hand, head, hips, jaws, knee, leg, nail, palm, shin, shoulder, skeleton, skin, stomach, thigh, thumb, toe, tooth, tongue, waist, wrist
- **injuries:** bruise, blister, bite, burn, fracture, fall, cut
– broken, pulled, swollen, twisted, sprained, dislocated, bleeding
- **common illnesses:** flu, cold, headache, earache, stomachache, backache, toothache, tonsillitis
- **contagious diseases:** jaundice, chicken pox, small pox, mumps, scarlet fever, rabies, SARS, AIDS, bird flu, swine flu
- **civilisation diseases:** asthma, diabetes, allergies, migraine, hypertension, heart attack, ulcers, epilepsy
- **respiration diseases:** tuberculosis, bronchitis, pneumonia
- **heart and blood circulation diseases:** heart attack, hypertension, angina pectoris, anaemia, stroke, arteriosclerosis, leukaemia
- **degenerative diseases:** osteoporosis, arthritis, multiple sclerosis, cancer, Parkinson's disease, Alzheimer's disease
- **venereal diseases:** AIDS, gonorrhoea, syphilis
- **skin diseases:** eczema, atopic eczema, herpes, psoriasis
- **symptoms:** high temperature, insomnia, spots, cough, sore throat, high/low blood pressure, rash, loss of appetite, diarrhoea, sweating, pain, vomiting, headache, running nose, sneezing, weight loss (gain), hallucination, cramps, constipation, paleness, nausea
- **causes:** stress, hectic lifestyle, insufficient sleep, polluted environment, sedentary work, lack of physical activities, overeating
- **doctors and specialists:** GP (general practitioner), dentist, ophthalmologist, paediatrician, physiotherapist, surgeon, plastic surgeon, psychologist, radiologist, virologist, dermatologist, gynaecologist, internist, cardiologist, homeopath, immunologist, urologist, rheumatologist, obstetrician
- **doctor's activities:** to examine a patient, to examine a patient's chest or throat, to listen to someone's breathing or heartbeat, to prescribe some medicine, to operate, to take blood count/throat culture/urine
- **medicaments:** painkillers (pain relievers), antibiotics, vitamins, dosage, pills, capsule, tablets, syrup, drops, ointment, cream, powder, spray, injection (AmE: shot), vaccine, infusion, side effects, to overdose
– pharmacy/chemist's, drugstore, pharmacist, prescription
- **healthy way of life:** eating fruit/vegetables, wholesome food, lean meat, doing exercises, have sufficient sleep, well-adjusted mind, undergo preventive medical check-ups, avoid smoking, stress and alcohol, prevention, vaccination
- **medical care:** hospitals (state, private, semi-independent/ward/surgery/doctor's office, waiting room), clinics, spas, maternity hospital, mental hospital, old people's home, nursing home, hospice
- **alternative medicine and treatment:** acupuncture, homeopathy, osteopathy, aromatherapy, acupressure
- **first aid kit:** thermometer, scissors, gargle, adhesive plasters, pills, drops, pain relievers, bandages, cotton wool, ointment, gauze, vitamins, disinfectants

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Why should people take care of their health?
2. Do you take care of your health? If so, what exactly do you do?
3. When do you go to see a doctor?
4. What questions do doctors ask their patients?
5. Can you name any medical specialists in English?
6. Which diseases do small children typically get?
7. Which disease/illness do you think is the most serious? Why?
8. What items does a first aid kit contain?
9. Do you believe in alternative medicine (such as acupuncture, homeopathy, aromatherapy, etc.)?
10. What are the advantages and disadvantages of using private health care establishments?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

RAISING HEALTH CARE AWARENESS

More and more people today seem to realise that good health means a longer and a happier life. Therefore, they **take better care of their health** than before. They eat healthier food, practise different kinds of sports and try to **avoid stressful** situations as much as possible. We need to be **in good shape** and also to have good **mental health** to be able to work and fully enjoy our lives. Doctors often **stress** that mental health **influences** our physical **condition**. Problems with **digestion**, **ulcers** or **migraines** are the results of mental problems such as depression, fear or anger. Bad eating habits, **lack of** physical activities, **sedentary work**, stress – all these factors cause **serious diseases**. A healthy, strong and beautiful body is the ideal for the **majority** of people and not only among the young. It is not so difficult to **pursue this aim** if you live in a developed country with good **health care**. However, in Third World countries, too many people are still **starving** and **epidemics of plague, cholera, typhus** and malaria are a part of everyday life, and not long forgotten epidemics of the past. Every year, many people **worldwide** become **victims** of **various** accidents. Most accidents happen on the road and many at work. In every country, a lot of different **security measures** are taken to prevent car accidents. Many children are **injured** playing outside or at home **handling** dangerous objects.

1. According to the writer, what do people do to stay fit?
2. What factors cause diseases?

IN A DOCTOR'S SURGERY

When we are ill, we usually see a doctor, called a GP (**general practitioner**). Sometimes we need to **have an appointment with** a specialist. The doctor **examines** our body, asks about the symptoms and usually **prescribes** some medication, **antibiotics**, **painkillers** or **vitamins**, which are usually **available on prescription** in a pharmacy. When the **illness** is too serious to be **treated** at home, the patient is taken to hospital and sometimes even **undergoes surgery**. People who are employed pay their **health insurance** monthly. They do not need to pay for basic health care and basic medication. When they want extra care or special **treatment**, they have to pay extra **costs**. Some people decide to go to a private health care **establishment**, usually for **surgery** (e.g. plastic surgery), **delivery** or **dental care**. Patients in our country are free to choose their doctors.

3. Describe what happens in a doctor's office (a surgery) when you go to see your GP.
4. What are patients supposed to pay for?

DISEASES AND TREATMENTS

Everybody has to **go through** various diseases during their childhood and adult life. Most of the diseases are not serious and do not take a long time to **cure**. Thanks to research in medicine (both in **diagnostics** and treatment), microbiology and chemistry, we now have **efficient medication** against diseases such as **flu**, **tuberculosis** or **scarlet fever**, which killed many people in previous centuries. However, there are diseases which we have problems in curing and some which we have failed to find a cure for. **Cancer** is one of the biggest **threats** nowadays. Every year, more and more people of all ages are **diagnosed with tumours** of all types. However, scientists continue to develop more and more efficient treatment techniques. We also get a lot of information about the prevention of cancer and its treatment. ***Daffodil Day*** is organised in many countries, including Slovakia. The money raised on this day is used to **fund scientific research** into the **causes** and treatment of cancer and to provide support for people with cancer and their families.

5. Which serious diseases are mentioned in the text above?
6. What is Daffodil Day?

ACQUIRED IMMUNE DEFICIENCY SYNDROME (AIDS)

AIDS is one of the most serious diseases that **threaten** people nowadays. It is a **viral disease** that **impairs the immune system** of the human body leaving it open to any infection. Those infections that are not dangerous for people with normal immune systems may be **mortally dangerous** for AIDS patients. According to the **World Health Organization** more than 34 million people are **infected**. AIDS was first identified in homosexuals, but later it was found among **intravenous drug abusers**, **haemophiliacs** and other persons who had received a blood transfusion, heterosexuals and their children. No cure or **vaccine**

for AIDS has yet been discovered. Many countries of the world spend a lot of money trying to find a cure. AIDS can be transmitted through infected **needles** and **sexual intercourse**.

7. Why is AIDS dangerous?
8. How do people get infected with AIDS?

EPIDEMICS

In the last decade, the world has been threatened by several epidemics. **SARS (Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome)** is a highly **contagious** disease, which was first **recognised** in 2003. The virus **spread** rapidly from Asia to other countries, including Canada, infecting hundreds of people. Scientists say that the development of effective **drugs** and vaccines for SARS **is likely to take a long time**. Another one, **bird flu**, is very contagious among birds and can also kill some domesticated birds (e. g. chickens, ducks and turkeys). Thousands of birds had to be killed after the virus appeared on farms all over the world. The virus does not usually infect humans and **transmission** from one person to another has not been observed yet. In 2009, the **emergence** of a new flu virus H1N1 (so called **swine flu**) killed many people in Mexico, the United States and many other countries. This virus has the ability to **pass from** one human **to** another. There is huge debate among **scientists, virologists** and doctors about the need to be vaccinated against these diseases. A recent epidemic in Europe (2011) caused a food scare due to the appearance of the dangerous E.coli bacteria in Spanish cucumbers.

9. What kinds of flu epidemics are discussed in the text above?
10. Which of the contagious diseases mentioned in the text does not have any effect on people?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

antibiotics [æntɪbaɪɒtɪks] – antibiotiká
to avoid – vyhnúť sa
bird flu – vtáčia chrípka
cancer – rakovina
cause – príčina
cholera [kɒləɹə] – cholera
condition – stav
contagious [kəntetdʒəs] – nákazlivý
costs – náklady
to cure [kjʊə] – vyliečiť
Daffodil Day – Deň narcisov
delivery – pôrod
dental care – zubná starostlivosť
diagnostics [daɪəgnɒstɪks] – diagnostika
digestion [dɪdʒestʃən] – trávenie
disease [dɪzi:z] – choroba
drug – liek, droga
efficient medication – účinný liek
emergence – vznik, objavenie sa
epidemics of plague [pleɪg] – epidémia moru
establishment – zariadenie
to examine – vyšetriť (u lekára)
flu – chrípka
general practitioner [præktɪʃənə] – praktický lekár
to go through – prejsť čím
haemophiliac (AmE: hemophiliac) [hi:məfɪliæk] – hemofilik
to handle – zaobchádzať
health care – zdravotnícka starostlivosť
health insurance – zdravotné poistenie
illness – choroba
to infect – nakaziť
to influence – ovplyvniť
to injure [ɪndʒə] – poraniť
intravenous drug abuser [æbju:sə] – človek, ktorý prepadol vnútrožilovému užívaniu drog
lack (of) – nedostatok
likely – pravdepodobne
majority [mə'dʒɒrətɪ] – väčšina
mental health – duševné zdravie
migraine [maɪgreɪn, also mi:greɪn] – migréna
mortally dangerous – smrteľne nebezpečný
needle [ni:dl] – injekčná striekačka

painkiller – tabletky proti bolesti
to pass from... to... – prejsť z... na...
to prescribe [prɪskraɪb] – predpísať, naordinovať
to recognise (AmE: recognize) – rozpoznať
(SARS) Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome – Syndróm akútneho respiračného zlyhania
scarlet fever [ska:lət fi:və] – šarlach
scientist [saɪəntɪst] – vedec
security measure – bezpečnostné opatrenie
sedentary work – sedavé zamestnanie
serious – vážny
sexual intercourse [ɪntəko:s] – pohlavný styk
to spread – rozšíriť sa
to starve [sta:v] – hladovať
to stress – zdôrazniť
stressful – stresujúci
surgery – ordinácia (BrE); operácia
swine flu [swaɪn flu:] – prasačia chrípka
threat [θret] – hrozba
to threaten [θretən] – ohrozovať
to treat [tri:t] – liečiť, ošetriť
treatment – liečba, ošetrovanie
transmission [trænzmiʃən] – prenos
tuberculosis [tjʊbɜ:kjələʊsɪs] – tuberkulóza
typhus [taɪfəs] – týfus
ulcer [ʌlsə] – vred
vaccine [væksɪ:n] – vakcína, očkovač látka
various – rôzny, rôznorodý
victim – obeť
viral [vaɪrəl] – vírusový
virologist [vaɪ'rɒlədʒɪst] – virológ
vitamin [BrE: vɪtəmin, AmE: vaɪtəmin] – vitamín
World Health Organization (WHO) – svetová zdravotnícka organizácia
worldwide – na celom svete
available on prescription – dostupný na lekárske predpis
diagnosed with tumors – diagnostikovaný nádor
to fund scientific research – financovať vedecký výskum

to have an appointment with – mať stretnutie s

to impair the immune system – oslabiť imunitný systém

in a good shape – v dobrej forme

to pursue an aim – sledovať cieľ, snažiť sa o dosiahnutie cieľa

to take a long time – trvať dlho

to take care of one's health – starať sa o svoje zdravie

to undergo surgery [s3:dʒəri] – podstúpiť operáciu

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Name the parts for the body.

The first letter of the words have been given to help.



Example: (čelo) F O R E H E A D



1. (ucho) E _ _
2. (krk) N _ _ _
3. (plece) S _ _ _ _ _
4. (prsia) B _ _ _ _ _
5. (hrud') C _ _ _ _
6. (rameno) A _ _
7. (lakeť) E _ _ _ _
8. (brucho) S _ _ _ _ _
9. (zápastie) W _ _ _ _
10. (dlaň) P _ _ _
11. (palec) T _ _ _ _
12. (chrbát) B _ _ _
13. (bedro) H _ _
14. (zadok) B _ _ _ _ _
15. (prst) F _ _ _ _ _
16. (stehno) T _ _ _ _
17. (koleno) K _ _ _
18. (lýtko) C _ _ _
19. (členok) A _ _ _ _
20. (palec na nohe) T _ _



21. (hlava) H _ _ _
22. (čelo) F _ _ _ _ _
23. (oko) E _ _
24. (mihalnice) E _ _ _ _ _
25. (obočie) E _ _ _ _ _
26. (nos) N _ _ _
27. (líce) C _ _ _ _
28. (brada) C _ _ _
29. (pery) L _ _ _
30. (čeluste) J _ _ _
31. (zuby) T _ _ _ _
32. (jazyk) T _ _ _ _ _

Task 2 Read the following expressions and explain their meaning in English.
Then, decide which activities are typical for doctors (D), patients (P) or both (B).

Example: to shiver with cold (P)

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|--|
| 1. to take someone's temperature | 11. to examine a patient |
| 2. to check someone's blood pressure | 12. to make an appointment with the doctor |
| 3. to make out a prescription | 13. to go through a regular check-up |
| 4. to have a sore throat | 14. to prescribe antibiotics |
| 5. to take an aspirin | 15. to get an injection |
| 6. to feel dizzy | 16. to have a cold |
| 7. to remove tonsils | 17. to suffer from diabetes |
| 8. to pull out a tooth | 18. to undergo surgery |
| 9. to take an X-ray | 19. to deliver a baby |
| 10. to stay in bed | 20. to put on/(lose) some weight |

Task 3 Put a tick (✓) next to those diseases and aches which you went through.
Talk about their symptoms.

Diseases and aches:

flu – chicken pox – herpes – toothache – tonsillitis – sunstroke – bronchitis – pneumonia – brain fever – eczema

Symptoms:

temperature – insomnia – spots – cold – cough – sore throat – high blood pressure – rash – loss of appetite – diarrhoea – sweating – pain – vomiting – headache – weight loss – hallucination – cramps – constipation – migraine

Task 4 What do the following doctors/specialists deal with? Which doctor would you go to see if you suffered from the diseases/pains/aches in exercise 3 above?

GP (general practitioner) – dentist – ophthalmologist – paediatrician – physiotherapist – surgeon – plastic surgeon – psychologist – radiologist – infectologist – dermatologist – gynaecologist – internist – cardiologist – homoeopathist – immunologist – urologist – rheumatologist – obstetrician